EMS — Roles and Approvals

How roles, reporting and approvals work in the CareerMap Solutions Employee Management System · 15 October 2026

This document explains, in simple words, how EMS handles roles, reporting and approvals.

It is built the way you described:

- everybody works under somebody,
- the person above approves,
- and the Super Admin controls all of it.

Please read it, and tell us in the last section if anything should be different.

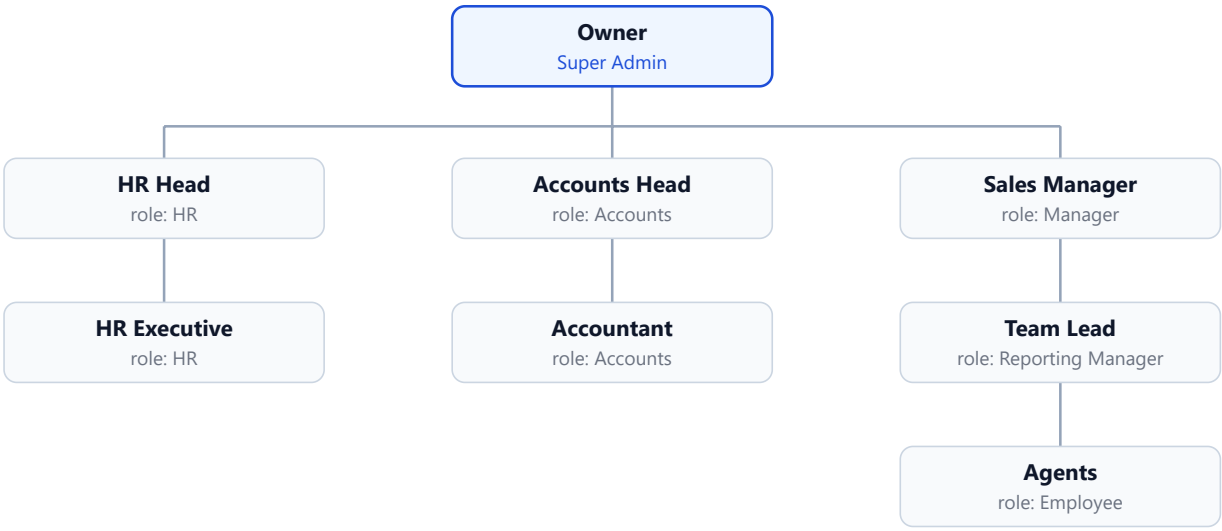
1. What you wanted, and how EMS does it

What you wanted	How EMS does it
The Super Admin controls roles and permissions. Nothing is fixed.	The Super Admin creates roles and decides what each role can do on one screen, gives roles to people, and sets who reports to whom (section 7).
Everybody works under somebody, and the person above decides.	The Super Admin sets who reports to whom. Approvals follow that (section 2).
Only the reporting manager approves leave. HR does not.	Leave always goes to the person the employee reports to (section 3).
Nobody does their own work, even if they are HR or Accounts.	Their own work goes to the person above them (section 4).
HR gives a new employee their Employee ID and password. The employee cannot change it; only HR can.	HR types the Employee ID and the password when adding the employee. The employee signs in with them straight away and cannot change the password; HR sets a new one when needed (section 5).
Every person with a role is also an employee, with two separate logins.	The Super Admin adds a role login on the employee's page, beside their employee login. Both are the same person (section 5).
HR negotiates salaries, so HR should see them.	HR can see salaries, but not change them, and not see their seniors' salaries. Accounts enters salaries (section 6).
The owner does not need anybody's approval.	The owner's leave is recorded directly (section 3).

Follow every employee from joining to leaving.	Each profile shows where the person is: onboarding, probation, confirmed, resigned, serving notice or left. HR takes each step; the reporting manager accepts a resignation (section 9).
Corrections, work from home, overtime and profile changes need an approval, and the company sets the rules.	Employees send these as Requests; the reporting manager or HR approves. Shift, overtime and leave rules are settings the company can change (section 10).

2. Everybody works under somebody

Every person in the company reports to **one** person. The Super Admin decides who reports to whom. People with a role, like HR, Accounts and managers, are part of this too.



An example. Each line goes up to the person who decides. An agent's leave goes to the Team Lead. The Team Lead's leave goes to the Sales Manager. The Sales Manager's leave goes to the Owner.

- **Only one person is marked as the owner.** Somebody whose manager has simply not been set yet is not treated as the owner.
- **Nobody gets missed.** If somebody has nobody above them, they show on a list for the Super Admin. Until the Super Admin places them, the Super Admin handles their requests.
- **The chart cannot go in a loop.** EMS stops “A reports to B” if B already reports to A.
- **Only the Super Admin moves people.** When HR adds a new joiner, HR chooses who they report to. After that, any change is made by the Super Admin, so nobody can take over somebody else's approvals by moving them.
- **Moving people is safe.** If somebody gets a new manager, their waiting requests go to the new manager, who is told. If a manager leaves the company, their team shows on the Super Admin's list until they are placed under somebody else. If a manager's login is turned off, their team's requests go to the Super Admin.

3. Who approves leave

Whose leave	Who approves it
Any employee	Their **reporting manager**, the person directly above them
A manager	The person above that manager
Somebody with nobody above them, or whose manager has left or cannot sign in	The Super Admin
When the manager is away	The Super Admin can approve instead of the manager, at any time
Cancelling leave that was already approved	The reporting manager, or the Super Admin
The owner	Nobody. It is recorded directly

- **HR does not approve leave.** HR can see all leave requests, give everybody their yearly leave, and correct a balance when needed.
- **Any person with people under them approves their leave**, whatever their role. For example, the Accounts Head approves the accountant's leave.
- Who approves when there is no manager, who stands in for the manager (the Super Admin, the manager's own manager, or nobody), and who can cancel approved leave can all be changed later by the Super Admin.

4. Nobody does their own work

The rule. A person who does HR, Accounts or Admin work can **never** do that work for themselves. People at the same level or below cannot do it for them either. **Only the people above them can.**

If the person directly above cannot do that kind of work, it goes up to the next person who can, and finally to the Super Admin. Nothing gets stuck. The owner's own items need nobody: they are recorded directly.

Work	For a normal employee	For somebody who does this work
Checking a bank account	Accounts	The person above that accountant, e.g. the Accounts Head. **Not** themselves, **not** another accountant
Correcting a leave balance	HR	The person above that HR person. **Not** another HR person at the same level
Checking a document (Aadhaar, PAN…)	HR or Admin	The person above them

Marking or correcting attendance	HR	The person above that HR person
Entering the monthly incentive	HR or Accounts	The person above them
Entering or changing a salary	Accounts	The person above that accountant
Confirming, extending probation, transferring, promoting, or completing the exit	HR	The person above that HR person
Approving leave	Their reporting manager	Their reporting manager

This rule applies to every role, including new roles the Super Admin creates. It cannot be turned off.

5. Two logins for people with a role

A person with a role (HR, Accounts, Admin, Manager or Reporting Manager) gets two logins:

Login	What it is for
Employee login	Their own things only: punch in and out, see their attendance, apply for leave, upload their documents, download their payslips, give their bank account.
Role login	The work of their role, for example HR work or Accounts work. Approving their team's leave is done here too.

- **Both logins belong to the same person.** The Super Admin adds the role login on that person's page (Employees → the person → Logins). This is how EMS knows it is the same person, so the rule in section 4 works from both logins.
- **Each login has its own password.** A role login needs its own email address. An employee login does not need an email: the person signs in with their Employee ID.
- **Signing in:** with the email, or with the Employee ID. Capital or small letters both work. For somebody with two logins, the Employee ID opens the employee login, and the role login signs in with its own email.
- The top of the screen always shows which login is open, for example “Signed in as HR” or “Signed in as Employee”. On a phone it shows the role as a small label.
- The Super Admin can turn one login off; the other keeps working. When somebody leaves the company, **both logins are closed together**, and they stay closed.
- A login added by mistake, for example with a wrongly typed email, can be withdrawn before anybody uses it, and then added again correctly.
- Normal employees have just one login.

Passwords.

- **HR sets employees' passwords.** When HR adds an employee, HR types their Employee ID and a password, and tells the employee. The employee can sign in at once. Nothing is made up by EMS.
- **The Super Admin sets role logins' passwords** (HR, Accounts, managers). HR cannot set them.
- **Nobody changes their own password**, except the Super Admin. Somebody who forgets it asks HR, or the Super Admin for a role login. The sign-in page and My Profile say so.
- **A new password signs out the old one.** When HR sets a new password, every phone or computer signed in with the old one is signed out, and the person is told in the app.
- **Employees added from a spreadsheet** with an email get a login without a password. They show as "No password yet" until HR sets one.
- A password must be at least 10 characters. Nobody, not even the Super Admin, can read a password once it is set.
- The Super Admin can change these choices in Settings → Users & Roles → Passwords: for example, let employees set and change their own password from a one-time link, or ask for longer passwords.

6. Salaries

Who	What they can do
HR	Agrees the salary with the employee. Can **see** salaries, but cannot change them, and cannot see the salaries of the people above them.
Accounts	Enters and changes salaries in EMS.
Everybody	Sees their own salary on their own payslips.

HR agrees a salary with the employee, and Accounts enters it. Every change is recorded in the audit log, and nobody can change their own salary.

Documents. HR checks everybody's documents, including those of the people above them. An offer letter shows the salary, so HR can read it there. The Super Admin can change whose documents HR sees on the Roles & Permissions screen.

7. The Super Admin controls roles

The Super Admin has a **Roles & Permissions** screen in Settings. From there, the Super Admin can:

- **Create a new role** with any name, for example "Finance Head" or "Team Lead".
- **Decide what each role can do** by ticking boxes, grouped by area: Employees, Salaries, Attendance, Leave, Payroll, Payslips, Documents, Reports, and Settings and users.

- **Decide whose information each role can see**, for employee records, salaries, attendance, leave, documents and payslips:

Choice	The role can see
Only their own	Only their own information
Their team	The people directly under them
Everybody under them	Everybody below them, at every level
Their department	Everybody in their department
Whole company, except seniors	Everybody, except the people above them. Useful for salaries
Whole company	Everybody

Whose payslips offers the same choices too. With anything beyond “Only their own”, the Payslips page gets a second tab, **People’s payslips**, listing the paid payslips of the people chosen, month by month, each one ready to download.

Whose payroll offers the same choices as the other areas and works the same way: whatever you choose decides whose payroll the role is shown. With “Their department”, for example, the role sees and works with only that department's salaries, incentives, income tax, loans, bank accounts, payslips, bank file and payroll reports, and its view of a month's payroll shows those people's figures, not the company's totals. What it can do is what you tick. The month's payroll is one for the whole company, so preparing, approving or marking it paid acts on everybody in it; the screen says so before it is done.

- **Give any role to any person**, in Settings → Users & Roles. A second login is added on the person's page (section 5).
- **Set who reports to whom** on the Company Tree screen, and the approval choices on the Approvals screen.
- **Set the order of roles**, for example HR comes under the Super Admin. A person can only give roles that are below their own.
- **Changes work straight away.** Nobody needs to log in again. Before saving, the screen shows what the role will be able to do.
- **“Reset to default”** puts one of the seven starting roles back to how it started.

Built-in safety. These are always on:

- The Super Admin role cannot be changed or deleted, and there is always at least one Super Admin.
- Nobody can change a role they have themselves.
- Nobody can give somebody a role that would let that person see more than they can see themselves.
- Nobody can set the password of, or turn off, the login of somebody above them in the company tree.
- The seven starting roles cannot be deleted, only changed or reset. A role that somebody still has, or that other roles come under, cannot be deleted.
- EMS warns if one role could both prepare and approve the payroll.
- Every change is saved in the audit log: who changed what, and when.

8. The roles EMS starts with

EMS starts with these seven roles. The Super Admin can change any of them, except the Super Admin role itself.

Role	What they do
Super Admin	Everything: approves the payroll, sees reports and the audit log, manages settings, users, roles and who reports to whom. Sets the passwords of role logins.
Admin	Looks after employee records and documents.
HR	Employees from joining to leaving: onboarding, probation, transfers, promotions and exits. Attendance, documents and holidays. Sees all leave, gives the yearly leave and corrects balances, but does not approve leave. Enters monthly incentives. Sees salaries, except seniors' salaries. Gives employees their logins and sets their passwords.
Manager	Sees their team's attendance and leave. Approves the leave of the people under them, as everybody with people under them does.
Reporting Manager	The same as Manager.
Accounts	Enters salaries, prepares the monthly payroll, checks bank accounts, and downloads the bank transfer file.
Employee	Their own attendance, leave, payslips, documents and bank account.

Everybody with a role also gets an employee login for their own things (section 5). Anybody with people under them approves those people's leave. A login for somebody who is not on the staff, for example an outside administrator, can be made in Settings → Users; it is not part of the company tree.

9. From joining to leaving

EMS follows every employee from the day they join to the day they leave. Each employee's profile shows the stage they are at, and a history of every step.

Stage	What it means	Who moves them on
Joining soon	Their joining date is still ahead. They cannot punch in or apply for leave before it.	Nobody: it moves on by itself on the joining day
Onboarding	They have joined. Their profile shows a short checklist: login, documents, bank account, PAN and reporting manager. HR marks onboarding complete.	HR
On probation	Probation runs 6 months from joining. HR can extend it, with a reason the employee sees.	HR confirms or extends
Confirmed	Probation is over.	—
Transfer and promotion	HR moves them to another department, or gives them a new designation. Who they report to is still changed only by the Super Admin. A pay rise is entered by Accounts.	HR
Resigned	The employee hands in their resignation in EMS (My Profile), or HR records a resignation letter. They can take it back until it is accepted.	The employee
Serving notice	The person they report to accepts the resignation and sets the last working day. The notice period is 30 days to start.	Their reporting manager
Left	On or after the last working day, HR completes the exit and records why they left. (HR can also do it earlier, if the company relieves them early.) All their logins close, and payroll pays them up to their last working day.	HR

- **HR does not accept resignations.** The person the employee reports to does, as with leave. That person, or HR, can also call a resignation off if the employee decides to stay.
- **People already working here** when EMS starts are added as Confirmed, with the date they were confirmed.
- **HR's own steps**, like confirming or promoting an HR person, are done by the person above them (section 4). HR also cannot change the record of anybody above them in the company tree; the Super Admin does that.
- **A resignation stays private until it is accepted.** Only the employee, HR, their reporting manager and the Super Admin can see it. An HR person who works under that employee does not see it, and when an HR person resigns, the other HR people do not see it either. Everybody else sees it once it is accepted.
- **Somebody who was to join but does not come:** HR closes their record. No working day is recorded for them.

- **The dashboard helps.** HR sees who is joining, who is still being onboarded, whose probation ends within 30 days, who has resigned and who is past their last day. A manager sees the resignations waiting for them.
- The employee is told about every step, and every step is saved in the audit log.
- The Super Admin can change the probation length and the notice period in Settings → Employee Lifecycle.

10. Requests, shifts and pay extras

Besides leave, employees ask for other things in one place: **Requests**. Each kind goes to one person, who approves or rejects it. A rejection always says why.

Request	What it is for	Who decides, to start
Attendance correction	A check-in or check-out that is missing or wrong. Once approved, the day is corrected.	Their reporting manager
Work from home / On duty	Days away from the office (home, a client visit, travel). On those days they check in without the office location.	Their reporting manager
Overtime	Time worked past the shift. Only overtime that is approved is paid, with that month's salary.	Their reporting manager
Leave encashment	Unused leave turned into pay, for leave types that allow it.	HR
Profile change	A change to their own phone, address, emergency contact and other personal details.	HR

- **The Super Admin chooses** who decides each kind (the reporting manager or HR) in Settings → Approvals, and whether working from home still needs a location reading.
- **The Super Admin chooses how check-in and check-out are proved** (Settings → Attendance Security), always exactly one way: **Location** (to start), **Selfie**, or **Location + Selfie**. Check-out is proved the same way as that day's check-in.
- **Location.** A phone must be within the office radius (15 to 20 metres, 20 to start), and its reading must be precise enough. A reading from outside, or one the phone is unsure about, is refused, with words that say what to do. Check-out is checked too. Somebody who has already left asks HR to record their check-out. A computer cannot be used, because its browser can be told any location. Location cannot be chosen until the office location is saved, and the office location cannot be removed while Location uses it.
- **Selfie.** A live photo from the front camera with every punch, from anywhere. It is kept for a set number of days (60 to start) and then deleted. The same photo sent twice is flagged.
- **Location + Selfie.** For more than one site, such as warehouses. The phone's current, **precise** location first, wherever the person is, then the photo. Without it the camera does not open, and nothing is punched. A phone set to **Approximate** gives a place 1 to 3 km wide: that is refused too, and the person is told how to turn precise location on. The Super Admin sets how rough a place may be (100 metres to start). Check-out works the same way. Nothing is checked against an office and no office location is needed: the place and the photo are kept with the punch, and HR sees the place on a map (Open map) in the day's Evidence, with every refused try.

- **A website cannot tell a fake location from a real one,** so EMS uses more settings together:
  - **The fingerprint machine confirms each day.** The app's attendance counts at once. When HR imports the machine's file, each office day is confirmed, or noted as at a different time, or marked "not on the machine" when the person never touched it that day. The company chooses whether such a day is only flagged or is made absent. A later file that has the day puts it back. Before payroll is run, it warns of days not yet confirmed.
  - **One phone per employee** (off to start), with any method. The first phone a person checks in from is theirs. A punch from another phone is refused, and the person is told to contact HR. Whoever has the right to replace phones (HR, Admin and the Super Admin to start; the Super Admin can change who in Roles & Permissions) opens the person's page and goes to Punch phone (on the Login tab). **Replace** makes the new phone theirs and stops the old one at the same time. **Reset** stops their phone, and the next new phone they check in from becomes theirs. Nobody replaces their own phone, or the phone of somebody above them.
- **Suspicious punches.** HR and managers see punches worth a second look under Attendance → Suspicious: refused punches, punches from a computer, readings that look too perfect or never move, and days not on the fingerprint machine. Each day's punches, with where, which phone and the photo, are under **Evidence** on the attendance list and on Suspicious. Nobody sees these signs on their own punches; the Super Admin sees everyone's. These are signs to look into, not proof.
- **How a day is marked.** On the nine-hour shift, 8 hours worked or more is a full day (Present), from 4½ hours a Half day, and less than 4½ hours Absent. No lunch break is taken off the hours, because lunch can be taken at any time: a day runs from check-in to check-out. The Super Admin can change these hours for each shift in Settings → Organisation → Shifts.
- **Shifts have rules.** For each shift: a grace period, when coming late or leaving early makes it a half day, and when overtime starts (after 30 minutes past the shift, to start). Late arrivals and overtime show on the attendance screen and in the reports.
- **Overtime pay** is off until you turn it on in Settings → Payroll Config, so nobody is paid overtime by surprise. Once on, it is twice an hour's pay to start; the rate, and whether it is worked out on the full salary or on Basic and DA, are set there too.
- **Each leave type has its own rules:** how many days a year, what a new joiner gets (the months left in the year; only whole months, so a month they join partway through does not count; or the full year), when it can be used (from the first day, after a number of days, or only after confirmation at the end of probation), days of notice, the most days in one go, who can take it (for example, maternity leave for women), whether it is earned all at once or a little each month, half days (first half or second half), and whether it can be encashed and how many days a year. All of these are in Settings → Leave Config, and apply to everybody.
- **One person can have their own days.** HR can give one employee a different number of days of a leave type (for example 15 days of Casual Leave instead of 12), when adding them or later on their profile, under Leave. The change applies to this year's balance at once. Days already taken are never taken back.
- **Loss of Pay** is an unpaid leave type with no limit: an employee can apply for it with no balance, it is approved like any leave, and each day is cut from pay. If an employee asks for more days than they have, EMS offers to take the days they have as paid leave and the rest as Loss of Pay, in one application. Their manager approves or rejects it as one.

- **Working from home is a Request, not leave.** It is not in the leave list; the leave form shows where to ask for it.
- **Attendance shows leave and pay.** On their Attendance page each employee sees each day as present, half day, absent, a holiday, a weekly off, or the leave it was (for example Casual Leave, or Loss of Pay in amber), the hours worked each day and in the month, and their **unpaid days (loss of pay)** for the month, counted the way payroll counts them, with the days not yet marked (paid until somebody marks them). The days paid are on the payslip.
- **Click a name to see that person's month.** On Attendance, a name opens that person's attendance: the month's calendar, each day, and the month so far counted up to today, with hours worked growing live while they are checked in. It also shows working days, days present, absent and on leave, and the unpaid days (loss of pay). The same page is the Attendance tab on an employee's profile. HR and the Super Admin can open anybody's; a manager can open their team's.
- **An absent day stays absent, and is cut from pay.** The employee is told when a day is marked absent, and the day offers **Apply leave**. If they still have leave and it is approved, the day shows as leave and is not cut from pay.
- **No check-in means absent.** When the Super Admin turns this on, a working day that ends with no check-in, no leave and nobody's mark is recorded **Absent — no check-in**, for everybody — from the day they were added to EMS, and on the app from the day they were given a login. On the app a day ends when the shift ends (a night shift, the next morning). Weekly offs and holidays are never absent. A check-in after all, approved leave, an attendance correction or HR's mark replaces it. Half a day of leave with no check-in for the other half: that half is absent. A month whose payroll is approved never changes.
- **Forgot to check out.** The day stays present. The person is told two hours after their shift ends, and HR sees the day under **No Out** on Attendance and puts the check-out in.
- **Marking several people at once.** Whoever has "Mark attendance" can tick people on the day's attendance and mark them together, with a reason kept on each day. Only the people ticked are marked. A day with a check-in is not offered: its times are kept.
- **The working week has a start day.** When the Super Admin changes the weekly offs, the change starts today or on the 1st of next month, and the days before keep the week they had; when the week is first set up, it can start on the 1st of this month (while this month's payroll is open). Every day goes by the week in force on it, the same on every screen and for every role.
- **Every leave balance has a statement**, like a passbook: every day given, taken, given back or corrected, with the reason, and the balance after each. HR sees the same on the employee's profile.
- **Before the leave year ends**, each employee is told once of the paid leave days they will lose if they do not use them (30 days before, to start; set in Settings → Leave Config).
- **Who else is away.** When a manager decides a leave request, they see who else in their team is on leave on those days.
- **Salary parts:** Accounts can add new earnings or deductions (a Site Allowance, a Bonus) and choose whether each counts for PF, ESI and professional tax. Bonus (outside ESI and professional tax) and Commission are there to start.
- **Loans and salary advances:** Accounts records the amount and how much to take back each month. It comes off the payslip every month until it is paid back.

- **Email:** every notice can also go by email, once the company's email account is connected to EMS. The Super Admin can keep any notice to the app only.
- **Reports** show each person only what their role lets them see. HR does not see payroll reports.

11. Other safety rules

- **Everything important is recorded.** Sign-ins, role changes, salary changes, payroll steps, documents opened and files downloaded all go into the audit log. Nobody can edit or delete it.
- **Passwords are set by HR and the Super Admin** (section 5). There are no shared or default passwords, and EMS never makes one up.
- **Yearly leave is given automatically.** A new joiner gets their share the day they are added, by each leave type's rule for new joiners. Everybody gets the new leave year on its first day. People who have left get none, and nobody gets it twice. Unused leave carries forward, up to the limit set for each leave type, once last year's leave still waiting for a decision has been decided. HR gives it by hand from Leave → Team Balances where EMS should not guess: somebody added without a joining date, a balance HR typed in by hand, or a leave type added in the middle of the year.
- **Payroll is approved by the Super Admin.** Accounts prepares it; only the Super Admin approves it. A payslip whose deductions are more than its pay (a negative net pay) cannot be approved: lower that month’s tax or deduction for the person, then recalculate. Once approved, that month cannot be changed.
- **PF and the Labour Codes.** The new labour codes say PF must be worked out on at least half of the pay. EMS has a switch for this in Settings → Payroll Config, off to start. When your accountant confirms it applies, the Super Admin turns it on. The share (50%) can be changed if the government announces a new one. It applies from the next month's payroll. The Super Admin also chooses there which parts of the salary count for PF (Accounts can set it too, under Payroll → Components) (Basic and DA to start; Special Allowance too, if your accountant says so). HR records on each employee's record whether they are in the pension scheme (EPS), from their PF record, so these settings never change it.
- **Bank accounts are checked** before any salary is paid into them (a setting, on to start). An account an employee sends in needs a photo of a cancelled cheque or passbook page.

12. What happens next

1. Everything in this document is built, and tested for every role, on computer and on phone.
2. EMS goes live. The Super Admin then sets up who reports to whom, the roles, and the role logins, and HR gives employees their logins, directly in EMS. You do not need to send us any data.

Is this what you wanted? If yes, please just confirm. If anything should be different, write it below, even small things.

Section	What should change